



The money changed. Can we follow the story backward and find the missing beginning?

MISSION: The Missing Money Mystery

The problem

Amira buys a notebook for \$8. After buying it, she has \$12 left. How much money did she have before she bought the notebook?

CLUE 1 - What is the problem asking you to find?

Say it in your own words. No calculating yet.

CLUE 2 - What do you KNOW about the money story?

Write what happened to the money. What amount do you know at the end? What happened just before that?

YOUR FIRST PATH - What will you try?

Draw money, count, write an equation, or tell the story backward. Pick a path that makes sense to you.

THINKING TOKENS



I understood it



I spotted the change



I tried backward



Hints are clues, not answers. Try your own idea first - even a wacky one!

Use hints one at a time.

Tip for printing: cover each hint with a sticky note or a strip of scrap paper. Reveal only the next one you need.

HINT 1 - NOTICE THE STORY

She had some money, spent \$8, and then had \$12. Which number tells you where the story ended?

HINT 2 - THINK BACKWARD

If \$8 was taken away, what could you do to the \$12 to undo what happened?

HINT 3 - PUT IT BACK

Imagine the \$8 notebook money magically jumps back into her wallet. How much would be there now?

HINT 4 - TRY THIS START

Start at 12 and count up 8 more. Where do you land?

BACK TO YOUR PATH

Now try again. What did the hint help you notice?



You followed the money trail! Show how you rebuilt the beginning before writing the answer.

1. Show your path

Show how you moved from what you knew at the END back to the missing START.

2. Your answer

How much money did she have at the start?

3. Another door?

Can you show the same idea a different way - maybe with a picture, counting up, or a different number sentence?

My second idea:

4. Choose the Thinking Moves you used

- | | |
|--------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|
| ☐ Used the story | ☐ Worked backward |
| ☐ Undid a change | ☐ Checked my idea |